

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

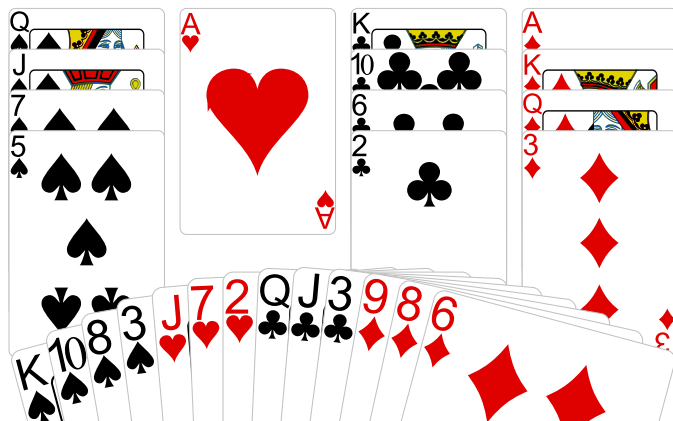
Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

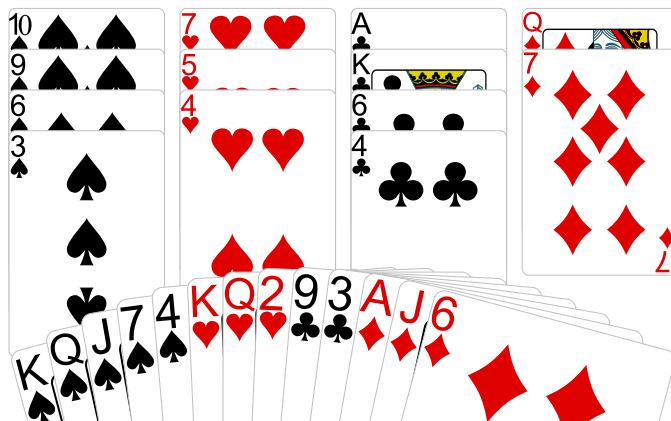
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



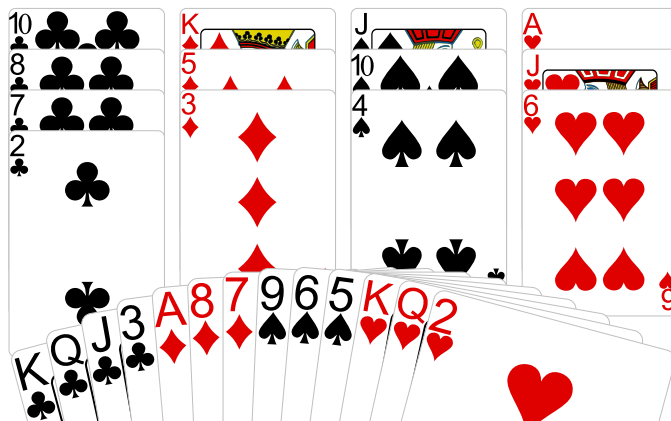
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 2
♥ K 9 6 5 4
♦ J 7 5
♣ A 9 8 4

7
8 6
19

♠ K T 8 3
♥ J 7 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ Q J 3



♠ Q J 7 5
♥ A
♦ A K Q 3
♣ K T 6 2

♠ A 9 6 4
♥ Q T 8 3
♦ T 4 2
♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1 ♦
All Pass			4 ♠

4 ♠ by North
she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game.

She bids 4 ♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 19

SOUTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start

with 1

♦

.

NORTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit

so he responds 1 ♠.

SOUTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ T 9 6 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ Q 7
♣ A K 6 4

8
9 16
7

♠ A
♥ J 9 8
♦ T 9 5 4
♣ Q J T 5 2



♠ 8 5 2
♥ A T 6 3
♦ K 8 3 2
♣ 8 7

♠ K Q J 7 4
♥ K Q 2
♦ A J 6
♣ 9 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠	Pass
4 ♠			
All Pass			
4 ♠ by East			

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 20

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

EAST has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1 ♠ rather than 1NT.

WEST isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2 ♠.

EAST has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3 ♠.

WEST has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4 ♠.

Deal 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 5 4

♥ 9 7 4 2

♦ 7

♣ 9 8 6 3

	12	
4		4
	20	

♠ Q T 8

♥ A J 6

♦ K T 9 3

♣ Q T 5



♠ K J 3

♥ K Q 5

♦ A Q J

♣ K J 4 2

♠ 9 6 2

♥ T 8 3

♦ 8 6 5 4 2

♣ A 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

4NT

All Pass

4NT by South

2NT

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 21

SOUTH has a perfect 2NT opening hand, 20 points and 3-3-3-4 distribution.

NORTH, with 12 points of his own, knows the partnership is borderline strong enough for slam.

Since he is happy with Notrump, he invites SOUTH to bid slam by responding 4NT.

With one more point SOUTH might bid the slam, but here she just passes.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 6 5
 ♥ K Q 2
 ♦ A 8 7
 ♣ K Q J 3

7
 15 9
 9

♠ A 8 7
 ♥ T 8 5
 ♦ Q J T 9 6
 ♣ 9 4



♠ K Q 3 2
 ♥ 9 7 4 3
 ♦ 4 2
 ♣ A 6 5

♠ J T 4
 ♥ A J 6
 ♦ K 5 3
 ♣ T 8 7 2

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2NT	
All Pass			
2NT by West			

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 22

WEST opens 1NT with 15 points and a balanced hand.

EAST, with 9 points, cannot bid game herself, but she can invite WEST to bid game if he

has the maximum 17 point opener. So she responds 2NT.

WEST doesn't have maximum, he has minimum, so he passes.

Deal 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 3
 ♥ Q 9 8 5
 ♦ Q T 3 2
 ♣ J T 6

9
 8 5
 18

♠ J 9 7 5

♥ 6 4 2

♦ A K J

♣ 7 4 2



♠ Q T 8 2

♥ A K

♦ 7 6 4

♣ A K Q 5

♠ A 6 4
 ♥ J T 7 3
 ♦ 9 8 5
 ♣ 9 8 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 23

SOUTH is 1 point too strong to open 1NT, so opens 1♣.

NORTH responds in his 4-card Major suit, 1♠.

SOUTH now shows her 4-card support plus her extra strength by jumping to 3♠ and NORTH bids the game.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			

Deal 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 4 3
♥ A 7 2
♦ K T 6 5
♣ 9 8 5

6
7 21
6

♠ A T 8 6 2

♥ J T

♦ 8 7

♣ J T 7 6



♠ 9 7

♥ 9 6 5 4 3

♦ A 4 2

♣ Q 4 3

♠ K Q J
♥ K Q 8
♦ Q J 9 3
♣ A K 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 24

EAST has a classic 2NT opening bid, 21 points and balanced distribution.

WEST knows that her 7 points will be plenty for game, but not enough to consider

slam so she just bids 3NT.

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East